

Sphea

BEAUTY FROM
THE SEA

ATHENA'S

PREMIUM

For over 55 years, Athena's has been active in the research and production of innovative cosmetics of the highest quality.

Since 1969, in its laboratories in the hills of Bologna, a team of experts has been developing formulas rich in active ingredients of 100% naturally sourced active ingredients, using carefully selected raw materials that combine proven effectiveness, pleasant touch and respect for both the skin and the environment.



INNOVATIVE FORMULAS WITH PATENTED MARINE INGREDIENTS

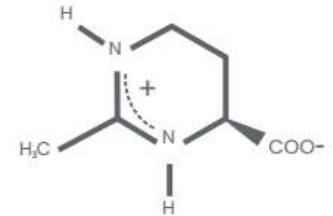
Sphea is a new high-end brand that offers a composite and innovative treatment, rich in specific benefits for the face and body. All the products in the line are characterized by a silky and remarkably hydrating texture, combining the effectiveness of the active ingredients encapsulated in pearls with those contained in the serum.

The real particularity of the collection Sphea lies in its precious pearls, made with natural marine biopolymers, which protect the active ingredients contained until the moment of applying on the skin.

The mechanical breakage of the pearls allows an ideal release, enabling the skin to fully absorb the active ingredients. Moreover, thanks to the synergy between serum and pearls, each treatment offers a double benefit in a single solution.

ANTI POLLUTION

Ectoin[®] natural
ULTIMATE PROTECTION & REPAIR



SERUM

Ectoine

100% natural molecule derived by bio-fermentation from micro-organisms living under extreme environmental conditions. It is an active and polyfunctional ingredient, boosting the skin's self-defence and cell repair systems.

PEARLS

Niacinamide

Revitalising, smoothing vitamin that favours the hydration of the epidermis and fortifies the skin barrier.

Coenzyme Q10

Strong antioxidant that counteracts the signs of ageing and prevents premature and cellular ageing by stimulating collagen synthesis.



The serum contains Ectoine, an anti-pollution moisturising molecule, which helps to protect the skin from atmospheric agents (UVA/UVB, heat, wind, etc.) and pollutants of various origins such as PM10, cigarette smoke, blue light, visible light and free radicals.

PROVEN EFFECTIVENESS

- Anti pollution
- Anti blue light
- Anti-oxidant
- Cellular reparative and protective
- Moisturising
- Anti-ageing

ECTOINE (inci: Ectoin)

Ectoine is a powerful natural molecule precisely because of its multifunctional profile, it expresses exceptional efficacy. Its benefits have been tested in numerous clinical studies:

- Global anti-pollution action (in vivo study)
- Protection against blue light (ex vivo)
- Anti-aging activity (in vivo)
- Long-term hydration and skin barrier repair (in vivo)
- Brightening and depigmenting efficacy (in vivo)
- Soothing-anti-inflammatory 'hydrocortisone-like' action (in vivo)
- Support of the skin microbiome (in vitro)

RESULTS: Reduction of pollution induced skin damage

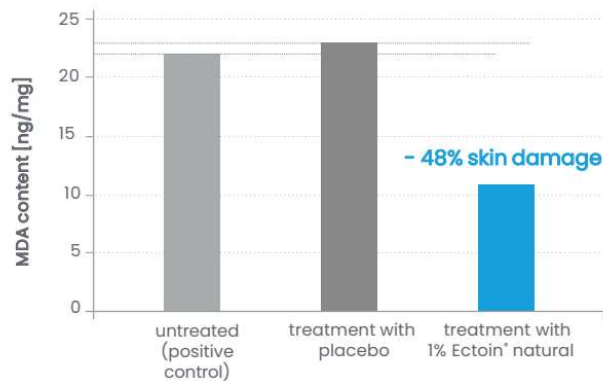
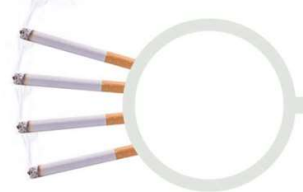
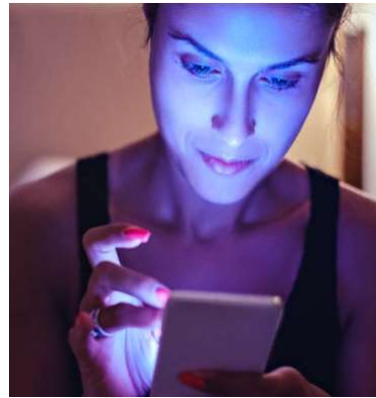


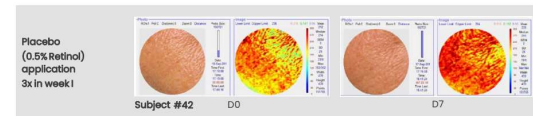
Figure 20: Reduction of pollution-induced skin damage.

After only 5 days of application with 1% **Ectoin* natural** the pollution-induced MDA content in the skin was reduced by 48% compared to the placebo-treated areas. In the same study set-up, a strong anti-oxidant was capable to reduce the pollution-induced MDA content in the skin by only 27% (data not shown).



SOOTHING EFFICACY (IN VIVO)

0.5% Retinol 3x/week



0.5% Retinol + 1% Ectoin* natural 3x/week

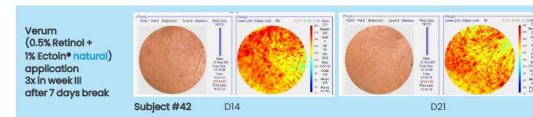


Figure 13: In vivo photographic images and TMAP700 measurements obtained from a representative volunteer show the soothing effect of 1% Ectoin* natural in a 0.5% retinol formulation. (D0-D13: no application)

Stress response of keratinocytes (formation of heat-shock proteins) 30 minutes after heat-shock

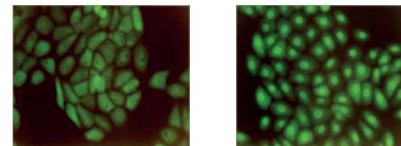


Figure 26: Microscopic images of fluorescent HSP 72/73 in the keratinocytes with and without Ectoin* natural pre-treatment.

Protection from UV-induced skin damage

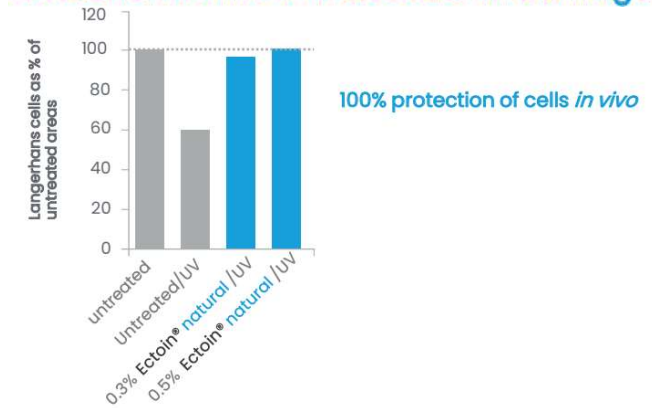


Figure 8: The amount of vital Langerhans cells in % after UV irradiation on untreated and pre-treated skin with 0.3% and 0.5% Ectoin* natural.

LONG-LASTING SKIN HYDRATION ("7 DAYS") (IN VIVO)

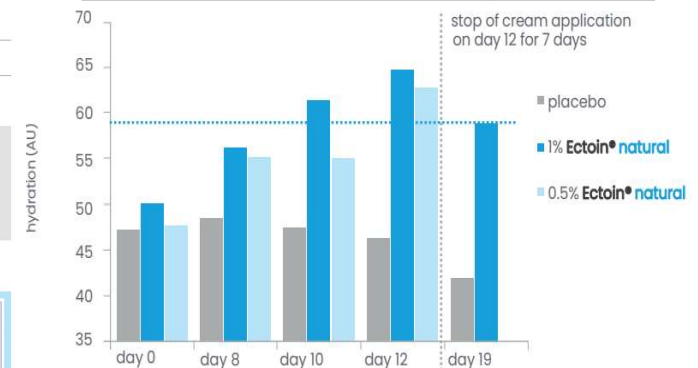


Figure 14: Long-term moisturizing effect with Ectoin* natural. Source: Graf et al., 2008.

Study protocol:

- double blind, placebo-controlled application test
- 5 female volunteers with normal to dry skin
- cream with 0% (placebo), 0.5% and 1% **Ectoin* natural**, applied 2x/day for 12 days on forearm
- skin hydration was measured from day 8 to day 12
- on day 12, application of cream was stopped for 7 days
- on day 19: detecting the skin hydration again for final result

RADIANT UP-LIFT

The Up-Lift face serum contains Uplevity® E-lift peptide whose properties improve muscle tone through a firming action on the facial contours similar to the effect obtained by a radiofrequency treatment.

PROVEN EFFECTIVENESS

Botox-like • Lifting • Smoothing • anti-wrinkles



SERUM

Uplevity® E-Lift Peptide

A latest generation molecule that stimulates fibroblasts, imitating the effect of an aesthetic radiofrequency session. It increases cellular energy, reducing wrinkles and performing a smoothing and lifting effect on the complexion.

PEARLS

Vitamin C

Evens out the complexion, promotes collagen and elastin synthesis, protects the skin from oxidative damage and counteracts ageing.

Niacinamide

Revitalising, antioxidant vitamin that improves hydration of the epidermis and strengthens the skin barrier.



Uplevity® E-lift peptide (inci:Tetrapeptide-1)

This peptide mimics the contraction effect of collagen fibres just as micro-current radiofrequency devices do during an aesthetic treatment, giving skin firmness and tone and reducing wrinkles.

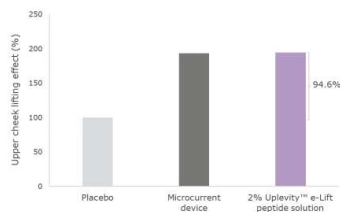
In vitro Tests

- Increase in MBNL1 PROTEIN in dermis cells and muscle cells
- Increased production of EDA- fibronectin
- Promotion of the contraction of collagen fibres
- Improvement in muscle tone of myofibroblasts (increase in mitochondrial membrane potential)

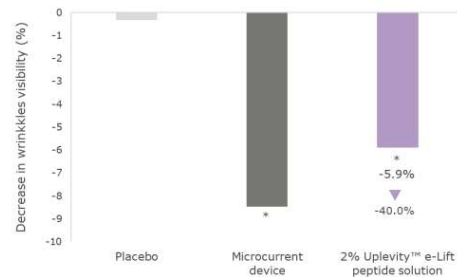
In vivo Test

- Tri-orbital lifting effect
- Reduction in the appearance of wrinkles

10 days of treatment with Uplevity™ e-Lift peptide solution
= 5 sessions of microcurrent device



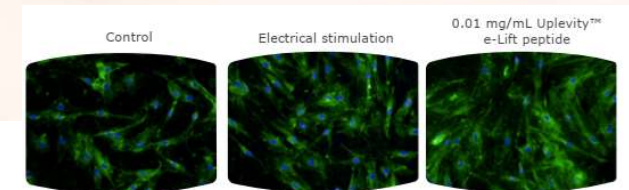
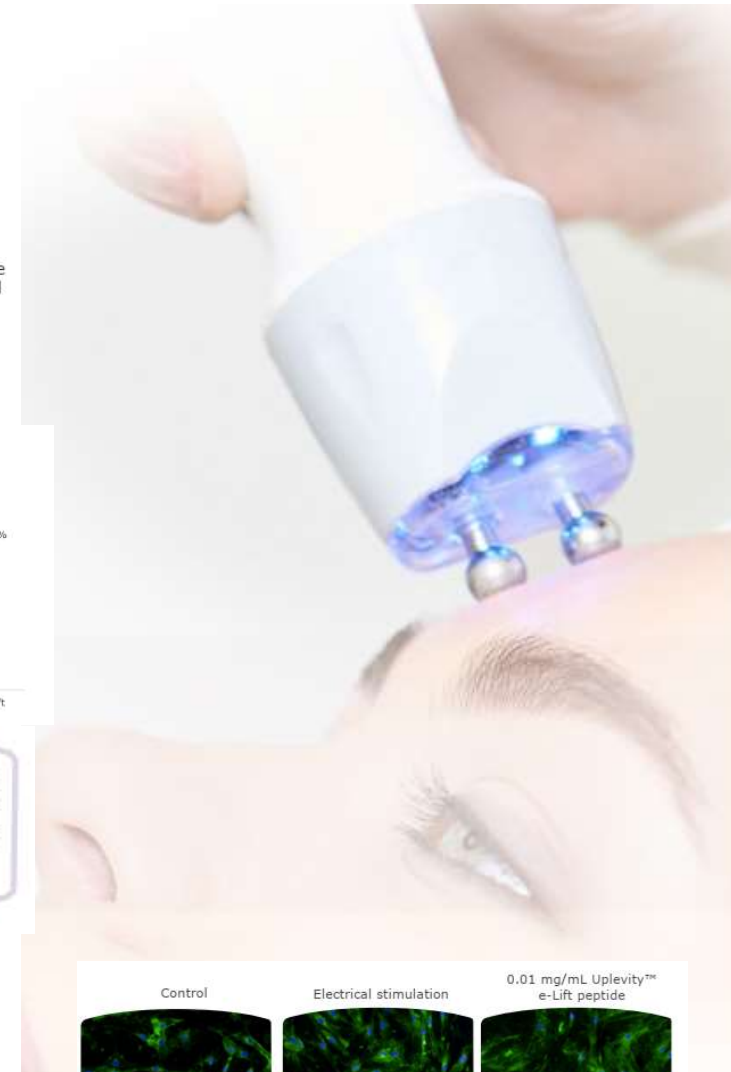
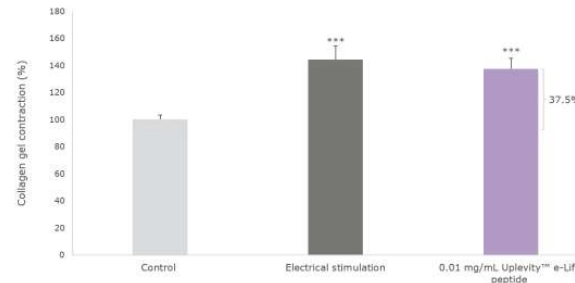
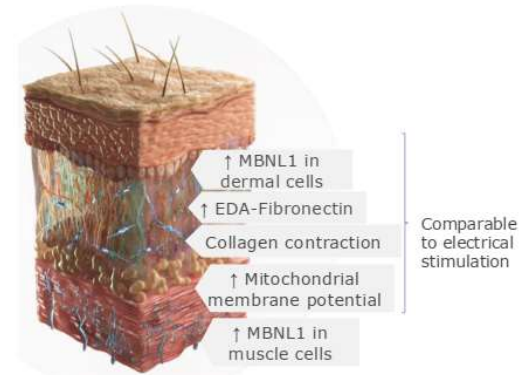
94.6% upper cheek lifting effect vs. placebo



Mimicking the collagen contraction capacity of microcurrents, *in vitro*, for firmer skin

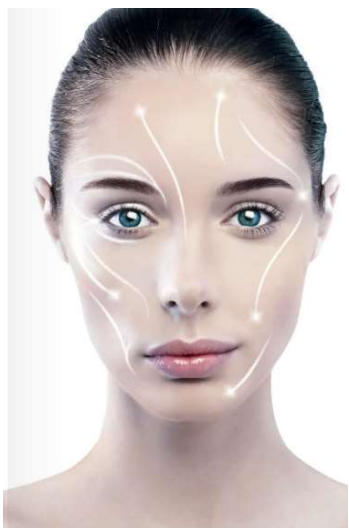


IN VITRO EFFICACY



72% increase in EDA-Fibronectin, *in vitro*, key for cell contraction and adhesion functions

EYELIFT PERFECTOR



The serum with Argireline® Amplified Peptide and Uplevity® E-lift Peptide smoothes expression lines with a botox-like, lifting and firming action around the eyes for a more radiant look.

TESTED EFFECTIVENESS

Botox-like • Lifting • Firming • Anti-wrinkles
• Anti-oxidant



SERUM

Argireline® Amplified Peptide, it works with a relaxing effect on the muscle fibre, similar to a botox-like action.

Uplevity® E-Lift Peptide

Latest-generation molecule that stimulates fibroblasts, imitating the effect of radiofrequency. Increases cellular energy, reducing wrinkles and conferring a smoothing and lifting appearance to the face.

PEARLS

Resveratrol

Powerful natural antioxidant, promotes the production of sirtuins, longevity proteins, and protects from free radicals and skin discomfort.

Raspberry Oil

Valuable nutrient for the skin, rich in omega 3/6 that promotes cellular health and regeneration.

Niacinamide

Revitalizing, antioxidant and smoothing vitamin that keeps the epidermis hydrated and fortifies the skin barrier.

Argireline® Amplified Peptide (inci: Acetyl hexapeptide-8)

Peptide made through processes of green chemistry, slows down the contraction of muscle fibres in the face, and accelerates their relaxation. It is precisely the repeated contraction of these muscles that causes expression lines. This Peptide gives the eye contour a smooth and lifting appearance, reducing the depth and length of wrinkles.

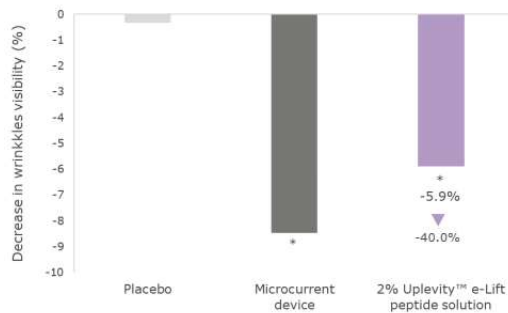
In vitro Test

- Increased cell viability of keratinocytes, fibroblasts, muscle cells and adipocytes - anti-ageing action.

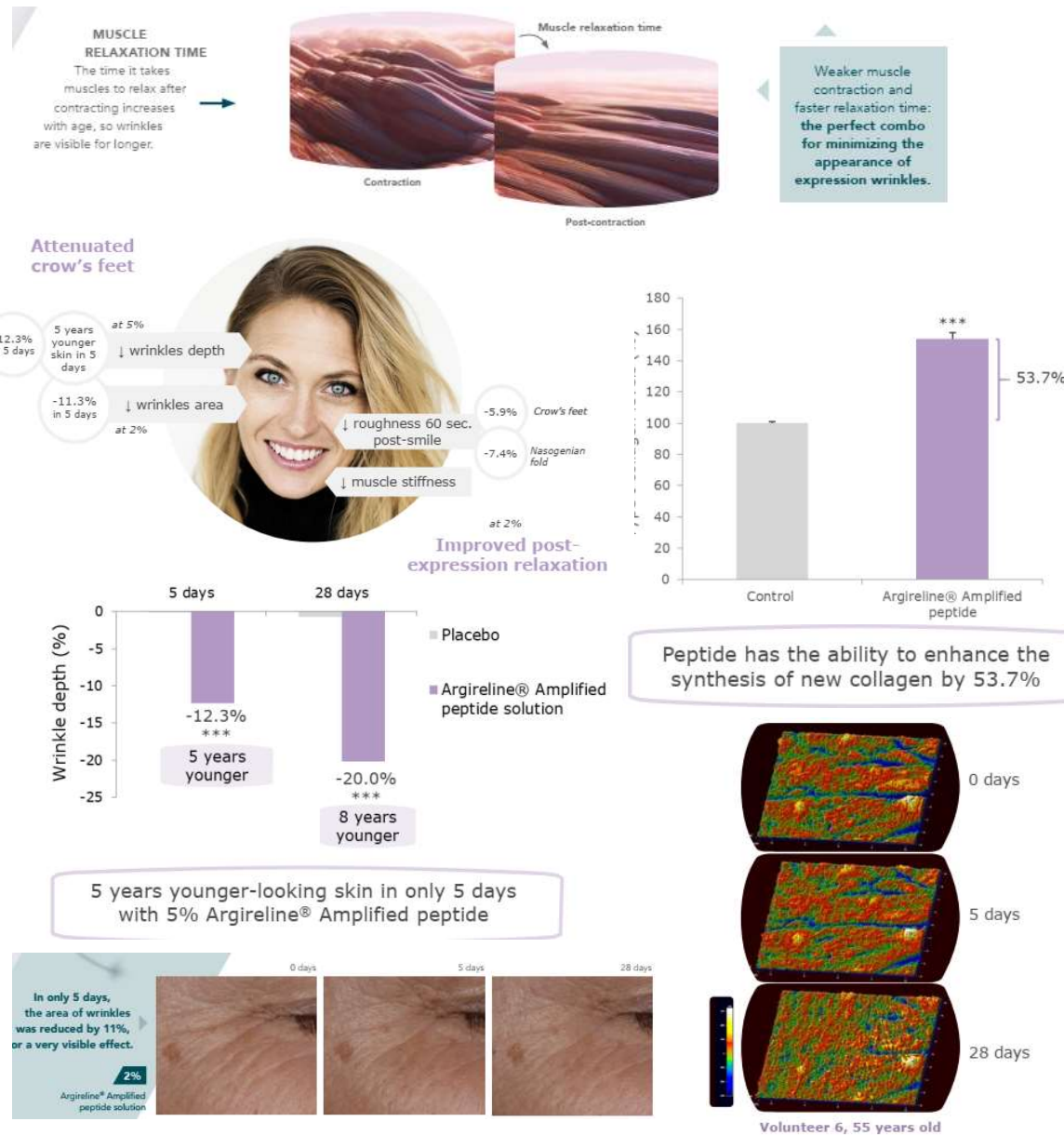
In vivo Test

- Lifting effect
- Decrease in skin roughness
- Increased radiance
- Minimization of wrinkles
- Enhanced skin resilience

Uplevity®E-lift peptide (inci:Tetrapeptide-1)



2% Uplevity™
e-Lift peptide
solution



SCULPT & FIRM



The serum with Actigym® marine ingredient mimics the effects of exercise by improving skin firmness and making it more compact, strong and toned.

It can be utilised as a post-workout treatment to boost the results of physical activity, for a synergic action.

TESTED EFFECTIVENESS

Reshaping Toning • Counteracts skin slackening
• Increases skin tissue density • Revitalizing



SERUM

Actigym® marine ingredient

Produced by a micro-organism that grows in the deep sea of the Bermuda Islands. It works by improving muscle tone, mimicking the effects of exercise or a gym workout. This **clinically proven active ingredient** helps to firm the skin, especially in critical areas such as the abdomen, arms, thighs and buttocks, providing a firmer, more sculpted appearance after just 4 weeks of use. Together with **caffeine**, it stimulates cell metabolism, helping to improve the vitality and appearance of the skin.

PEARLS

Niacinamide

Boosts skin regeneration and the synthesis of collagen and elastin, restoring elasticity and radiance.

Resveratrol

Powerful natural antioxidant, promotes the production of sirtuins, longevity proteins, and protects from free radicals and skin discomfort.

Raspberry Oil

Valuable nutrient for the skin, rich in omega 3/6 that promotes cellular health and regeneration.

Vitamin C

Preserves the skin from oxidative damage and counteracts the ageing processes.

Actigym® marine ingredient (inci: Bacillus/Soybean ferment extract)

In vitro Test

- Increased ADIPONECTIN release by adipocytes
- Increased mitochondrial activity in muscle fibres
- Inhibition of lipid accumulation in adipocytes

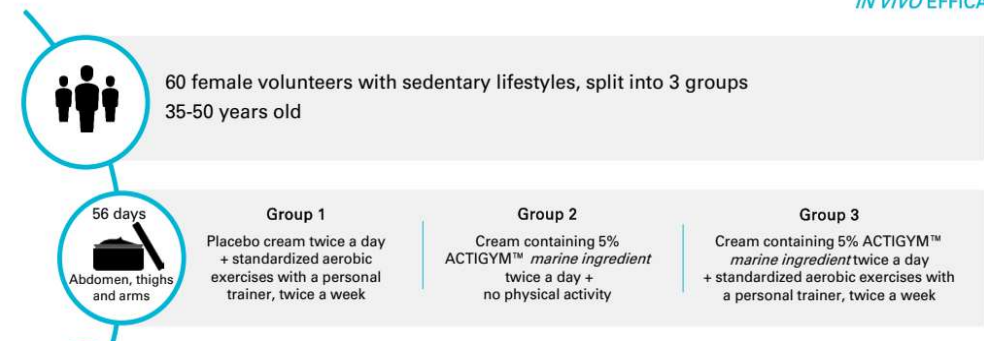
In vivo Test

- Body re-shaping effect
- Reduction in wrinkles appearance



Endurance training induces adiponectin release, which regulates metabolism in muscle fibers

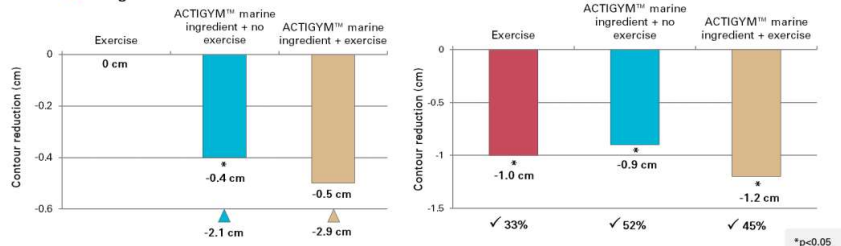
IN VIVO EFFICACY



CENTIMETRIC MEASUREMENTS (II)

IN VIVO EFFICACY

Thigh contour.



0 days 56 days

5% ACTIGYM™ marine ingredient + no exercise



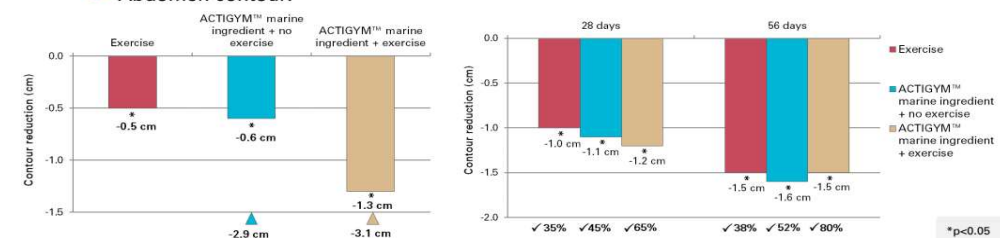
5% ACTIGYM™ marine ingredient + exercise



CENTIMETRIC MEASUREMENTS (I)

IN VIVO EFFICACY

Abdomen contour.



Macroscopic images of the abdomen.



SLIM SILHOUETTE

The serum contains the ingredient **Nocturshape® blue** which acts by reducing the visibility of cellulite. This active is designed to benefit from the body's circadian rhythms and acts during the night hours by facilitating lipolysis.

TESTED EFFECTIVENESS

- Slimming anti-cellulite
- Lipolytic activity
- Draining

HOW TO USE

To obtain excellent results, apply the serum preferably at night to benefit from its night-time lipolysis potential.

Massage over the affected areas until completely absorbed.



SERUM

Nocturshape® blue ingredient

An advanced ingredient produced by a marine micro-organism, it exploits the body's circadian rhythms by working overnight on nocturnin in the adipocytes, a protein involved in the accumulation of lipids. This **clinically proven** active reduces thigh circumference and the 'orange peel' effect, providing a general improvement in the appearance of cellulite, **already after 15 days of use**. It boosts nocturnal metabolic processes, helping to reduce fat build-up.

Caffeine

Stimulates cell metabolism, improves the skin's microcirculation and promotes the drainage of liquids and toxins.

PEARLS

Niacinamide

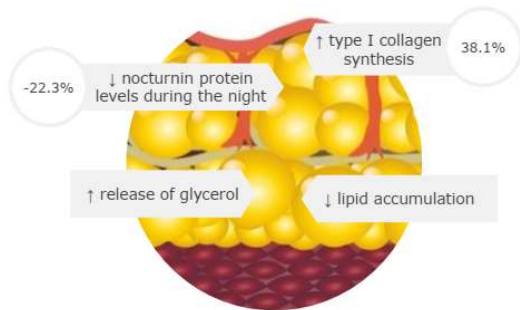
Skin regenerator, promotes collagen and elastin synthesis, returning elasticity and radiance to the skin.

Coenzyme Q10

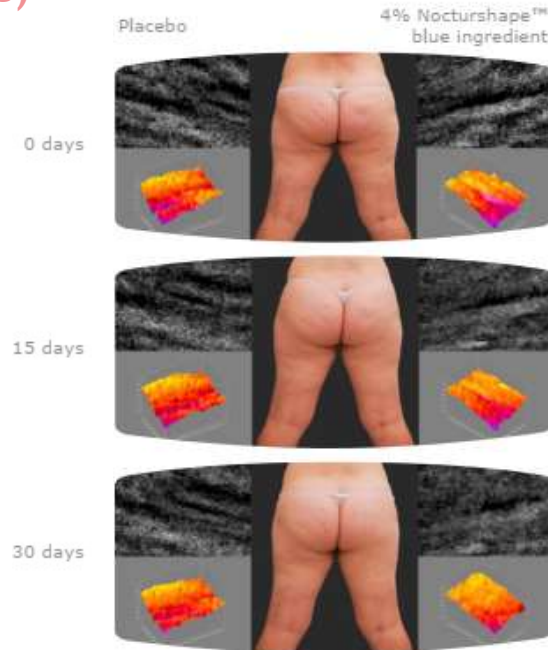
Powerful antioxidant with anti-reddening and soothing properties.

Nocturshape®blue ingredient (inci: Saccharide isomerate)

IN VITRO EFFICACY



IN VIVO EFFICACY



Left side: placebo
Right side: 4% Nocturshape™ blue ingredient

After 30 days use at 4% the homogeneity of skin temperature improved by 39.4%.

Nocturshape™ blue ingredient reduced the uneven fat build-up and improved microcirculation

Improvement of cellulite appearance (I)



20 females (25-47 years old) with cellulite grades II and III (Nurnberger-Muller scale)

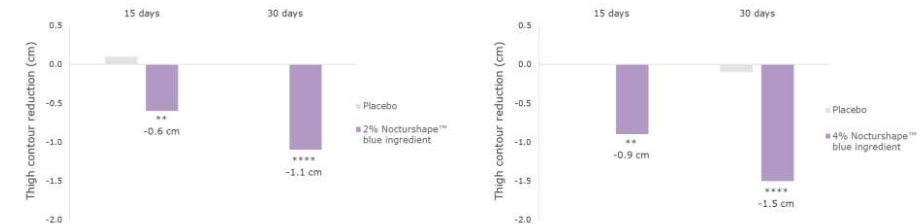


Cream containing 4% Nocturshape™ blue ingredient on one side of the body or placebo cream on the other side. Once daily at night, on hips and thighs 30 days.

Improvement of cellulite appearance (II)

Reduction of thigh contours

The mean reduction in thigh circumference was calculated by image analysis from digital photos of the subjects.



Nocturshape™ blue ingredient reduced thigh contours by 0.9 cm after 15 days and by 1.5 cm after 30 days

PRODUCTS CERTIFICATIONS

The products boast certifications attesting to their quality, safety and compliance with the highest industry standards.

Natural origin ingredients > 90%

SOLAR ENERGY

Thanks to its photovoltaic system Athena's uses clean energy for over 80% of its needs.



VEGAN COSMETIC

Athena's, in accordance with European regulations, is opposed to animal testing. The products are vegan because they do not contain raw materials of animal origin or obtained through the exploitation of animals.



ECO FRIENDLY

We exclusively use bottles, boxes and packaging in recycled and/or recyclable materials and ingredients biodegradable and environmentally friendly.



DERMATOLOGICALLY TESTED PRODUCTS

The company benefits from the collaboration of the Department of Cosmetology at the University of Ferrara to perform studies for product evaluation and efficacy, skin and eye tolerability and microbiological control.





Spheea

Sphea

Disclose on yourself
the beauty that comes from the Sea

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